hiveschool .

AI Marketing Fellowship

Marketing **Entrepreneurship**



25+

Founders, CMOs and brand heads teach, including leaders from

Nestlé · Swiggy · Snitch

9 Months

6 months building your own brand, then 3 months of placements

Own brand · Demo Day

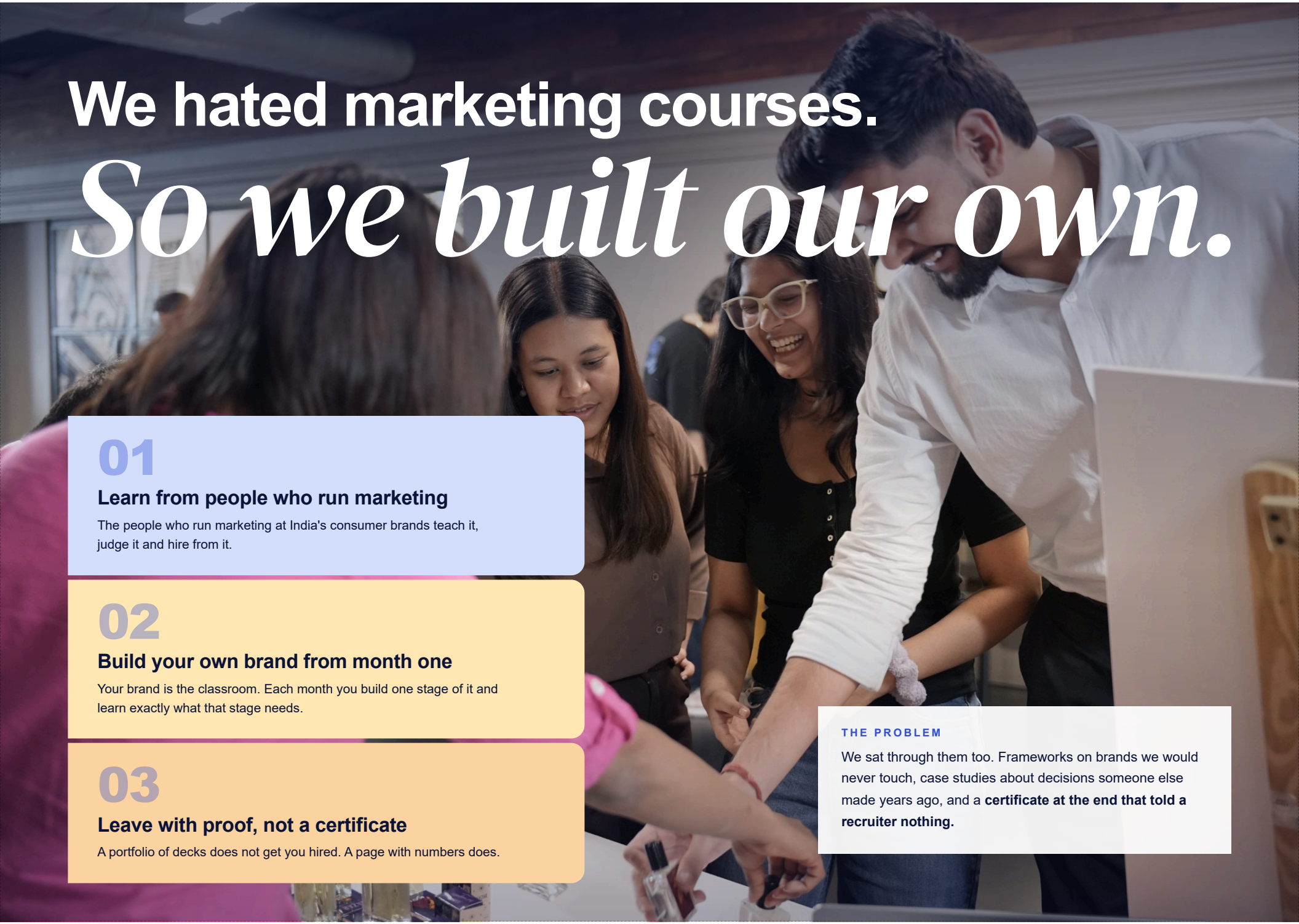
100+

Live briefs from partner brands, including

Zepto · Cipla · Culture Circle

ON CAMPUS, GURUGRAM

BATCH STARTS APRIL 2027



We hated marketing courses.

So we built our own.

01

Learn from people who run marketing

The people who run marketing at India's consumer brands teach it, judge it and hire from it.

02

Build your own brand from month one

Your brand is the classroom. Each month you build one stage of it and learn exactly what that stage needs.

03

Leave with proof, not a certificate

A portfolio of decks does not get you hired. A page with numbers does.

THE PROBLEM

We sat through them too. Frameworks on brands we would never touch, case studies about decisions someone else made years ago, and a **certificate at the end that told a recruiter nothing.**

Learn from India's leading

Brand Builders

25+ founders, CMOs and brand heads from India's consumer brands



Neha Gulati

Ex-Head of Brand

Nestlé



Siddarth Menon

Ex-CMO

Epigamia



Simar Sekhri

CMO

HiveSchool



Aniket Singh

Chief Business Officer

Snitch



Sidharth Bhakoo

Chief Business Officer

Swiggy



Saurabh Sen Gupta

VP Sales

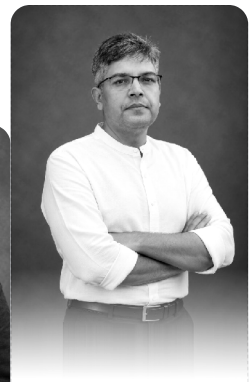
Zomato



Prashanth Kamath

Digital Marketing

Straive



Ajay Singh

Quick Commerce

Cipla Cipla

Mentors teach the modules, judge the challenges and hire from the batch.



So we built the programme we wanted at 22. You learn marketing by **doing it on a live brand**, and the people who run marketing at India's consumer brands **teach it, judge it and hire from it.**

— **The marketers behind the Fellowship**

RECENT SESSIONS

Aniket Singh, Chief Business Officer, Snitch

Sidharth Bhakoo, Chief Business Officer, Swiggy

Six Months, *One Brand*

The Fellowship is **9 months, full time, on campus in Gurugram**. For six months you **build your own brand**, one stage at a time, and learn exactly what that stage needs. Then you **get placed or get funded.**

Your brand is the classroom

Build:

Each month you build one stage of your brand: **idea, MVP, launch, scale, product-market fit** and **fundraise.**

Pitch:

Each month ends in a harder room: **D2C founders, accelerators, the Hive Incubation Cell, CMOs, angel investors**, then **Demo Day.**

Where the work gets judged:



Month-end pitch


Fellowship Demo Day

Capstone:

A real project for **another company every month**, from a consumer research study to an investor narrative.

Live briefs:

Every Wednesday a brand walks in with **a problem it has right now.** Teams of four get seven days.

Your Page is *Your Proof*

A portfolio of decks does not get you hired. **A page with numbers does.** In week one you are handed a **partner brand's page**. For six months you grow it, and when placements start, **the page is your proof.**

Runs through all six months

Get a brand

A live page, or a new handle to start from zero.

Crack the platforms

Organic reach, paid reach and the marketplaces.

Grow it, in public

A weekly scoreboard the whole batch can see.

Reviewed monthly

With the brand, not only with faculty.


On campus, Gurugram

Measured every Friday

Instagram · YouTube · LinkedIn · WhatsApp · Meta Ads · Google Ads · Amazon · Blinkit · Zepto

ENTREPRENEURSHIP

Build a brand in six months. *Pitch it every month.*

The best way to learn marketing is to build a brand. On one side you build your brand, stage by stage. On the other, the curriculum teaches what that stage needs, with a capstone for another company. **Each month ends with a pitch, and the rooms get harder.**

M1 Idea · M2 MVP · M3 GTM · M4 Scale · M5 PMF · M6 Fundraise · M7 to 9 Your track

Month 1 · The Mom Test

Find the *idea*

Find a problem *worth solving*

ON YOUR BRAND

Talk to 30 potential customers without pitching. Pick a problem and size the market.

MONTH-END PITCH

A room of early D2C and agency founders, to test if the idea is viable.

Month 2 · Product and MVP

Build the *MVP*

Make the first product *and sell it*

ON YOUR BRAND

Name it, design it, source it, price it. Open your store and get the first 10 orders.

MONTH-END PITCH

Early-stage accelerators.

Month 3 · GTM

Go to *market*

Launch it *to the world*

ON YOUR BRAND

Launch with content, creators and your first paid ads. Sell offline at Sell on Streets.

MONTH-END PITCH

The Hive Incubation Cell, for iterations on your plan.

Month 4 · Scaling

Scale across *channels*

Take it *everywhere people buy*

ON YOUR BRAND

List on marketplaces and quick commerce, run retail media ads, build search presence.

MONTH-END PITCH

A room of CMOs and brand heads, for feedback on your GTM and channel plan.

Month 5 · Product-market fit

Find *PMF signals*

Prove people *come back*

ON YOUR BRAND

Track repeat purchase, CAC and contribution margin. Build retention journeys.

MONTH-END PITCH

Angel investors.

Month 6 · Fundraise — Demo Day

Raise *the round*

Fellowship *Demo Day*

ON YOUR BRAND

Build your financial model, deck, data room and brand story.

MONTH-END PITCH

A room of investors, VCs and founders, to raise a cheque.

MONTHS 7 TO 9 · YOUR TRACK

Keep building, *or get hired*

INCUBATE

Keep building your brand inside the Hive Incubation Cell, backed by the ₹50 lakh Fellowship Incubation Investment Fund.

PLACEMENTS

A three-month placement season with brand, agency, commerce and creative recruiters.

CURRICULUM

Four tracks. Six months. *One brand* you build.

The curriculum runs on two sides at once. In the **Venture Studio** you build your own brand, stage by stage. In the other three tracks you learn **brand, growth and creative**, apply each sprint to your brand, and solve a live problem for a partner company. **Every sprint ends with something shipped.**

4	6	49	49	49
Tracks	Months of building	Sprints	Capstones	Live brand briefs





The four tracks

What you learn, track by track

TRACK 1 · ENTREPRENEURSHIP

Venture *Studio*

The spine of the program. You find an idea, make a product, sell it, prove people come back and raise money.

- Customer discovery
- Sourcing, costing, pricing
- Operations and channel economics
- PMF, unit economics, fundraising

TRACK 2 · BRAND

Brand *House*

How brands are built and remembered: insight, positioning, identity, launches, community and brand health.

- Insight and positioning
- Naming, identity, packaging
- Campaigns, PR, influencers
- Brand health, extension, architecture

TRACK 3 · GROWTH

Growth *Engine*

Every channel that turns attention into revenue, paid and unpaid, and the numbers that tell you what is working.

- Meta, Google, YouTube
- Marketplaces and quick commerce
- SEO and AI search, CRM
- Analytics, media planning

TRACK 4 · CONTENT AND CREATIVE

Creative *Floor*

The full journey of an ad: the idea, the script, the shoot, the edit, the test, and the next version.

- Ideas, scripts, storyboards
- Directing and production
- Editing, motion, AI video
- Performance creative, series

How every sprint works

Learn it. Build it. Solve it for a brand.

01

What you learn

Short, practitioner-led sessions on one skill, with the frameworks working marketers use.

02

What you build

A capstone shipped on your own brand. In the Venture Studio, it is the next milestone of the business.

03

Live brief

A problem statement from a partner brand, solved in teams and presented to someone from that brand.

04

Outcome

What you can show at the end: a number, a live asset, a decision you can defend.





What runs through all six months

Weekly brand challenges

A live brief every Wednesday, ending in Hire, Interview or Pass.

Creator Lab

Every fellow builds a personal content channel from month 1.

AI Studio

One AI workflow built and used on your brand each month.

Weekly numbers

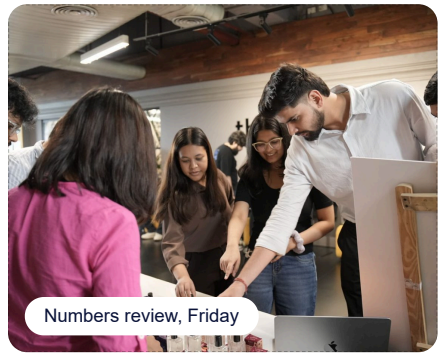
Your brand's P&L and metrics reviewed with faculty every Friday.

03 AI Studio, month by month

M1 · Find the idea	Research workflows: review mining, social listening, interview synthesis
M2 · Product and MVP	Design, product imagery, copy and store building
M3 · Go to market	An ad creative engine: briefs, variants, iteration. AI video
M4 · Scale	Listing and catalogue generation, keyword research, an AI search audit
M5 · PMF signals	CRM journey automation, AI analysis and reporting
M6 · Fundraise	Pitch deck and data room drafting
M7 to 9 · Your track	Interview practice with AI



Live brief, Wednesday


Numbers review, Friday

MONTH 1 · THE MOM TEST · TRACKS 1 AND 2

Find the *idea*



MONTH-END PITCH
A room of early D2C and agency founders, to test viability

TRACK 1 · 2 SPRINTS

Venture *Studio*

END OF MONTH

A validated problem, a sized market and an idea memo you can defend in front of founders.

SPRINT 1

Problems worth *solving*

Talk to customers before you build anything

WHAT YOU LEARN

+ The Mom Test: questions that get facts, not compliments
+ Jobs to be done and switching triggers
+ Problem interviews vs solution interviews
+ Founder-market fit and picking a category you can win
+ Opportunity scoring: pain, frequency, willingness to pay

WHAT YOU BUILD

30 customer interviews, logged and coded, and a one-page problem memo for your brand.

OUTCOME

One problem, backed by interview evidence, that you would bet six months on.

LIVE BRIEF

Culture Circle PARTNER

"Sneaker fans browse resale for weeks but never buy their first pair. Find out why."

SPRINT 2

Sizing the *market*

How big, how fast, and who already owns it

WHAT YOU LEARN

+ Bottom-up market sizing: TAM, SAM, SOM
+ Category maps and competitor teardowns
+ Lean Canvas and the riskiest assumption
+ Kill criteria: when to drop an idea
+ Reading D2C funding and category reports

WHAT YOU BUILD

A bottom-up market model and Lean Canvas for your idea, with the riskiest assumption named.

OUTCOME

A market model in a sheet, and a go or no-go call on your idea.

LIVE BRIEF

Dohful PARTNER

"Size the market for a premium cookie store in a tier-2 city and pick the first city to open in."

TRACK 2 · 2 SPRINTS

Brand *House*

END OF MONTH

A category map and three consumer insights your brand will be built on.

SPRINT 1

How brands *grow*

The science of being remembered and being easy to buy

WHAT YOU LEARN

+ Mental and physical availability (Byron Sharp)
+ Category entry points: the moments people think of a category
+ Brand building and activation: the long and the short of it (Binet and Field)
+ Brand equity models (Keller)
+ Why distinctive assets beat clever ads

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND

A brand audit of the three leading brands in your category, with their entry points mapped.

OUTCOME

A category map showing where your brand can win.

LIVE BRIEF

Epigamia ILLUSTRATIVE

"Greek yoghurt is a breakfast habit. Find two new moments Epigamia should own."

SPRINT 2

Insight *hunting*

From what people say to what they actually feel

WHAT YOU LEARN

+ Observation vs insight vs idea
+ Review mining and social listening with AI
+ Ethnography: watching people shop
+ Cultural tensions and category codes
+ Personas that change decisions

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND

An insight deck for your brand: three insights, each with evidence and a "so what".

OUTCOME

Three insights you can trace back to real people.

LIVE BRIEF

PeeSafe PARTNER

"First-time buyers feel awkward at checkout. Find the insight that gets them past it."

MONTH 1 · THE MOM TEST · TRACKS 3 AND 4

Find the *idea*



MONTH-END PITCH
A room of early D2C and agency founders, to test viability

TRACK 3 · 2 SPRINTS

Growth *Engine*

END OF MONTH
Proof of demand: a channel map and a smoke test with real clicks and sign-ups.

SPRINT 1

The growth *map*

How brands in India actually acquire customers

WHAT YOU LEARN
- The funnel and the AARRR framework
- The language of growth: CAC, AOV, LTV, contribution margin
- Biddable, non-biddable and owned media, explained
- How Indian D2C brands grow: D2C site, marketplaces, quick commerce, offline
- Where each channel fits by price point and category

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND
A channel map for your brand: where your buyers discover, compare and buy.

OUTCOME
A ranked list of channels to test first, with reasons.

LIVE BRIEF
Fixmycurls PARTNER
"Map where curly-haired buyers discover and buy hair products today."

SPRINT 2

Demand *signals*

Test demand before you make the product

WHAT YOU LEARN
- Keyword research: Google Keyword Planner and Trends
- Marketplace search data and bestseller lists
- Competitor ads in the Meta Ad Library
- Smoke tests: a landing page, a waitlist and a small ad budget
- Reading early numbers: CTR, cost per sign-up

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND
A live landing page and waitlist for your brand, tested with a small ad budget.

OUTCOME
Real sign-ups, and a cost per interested customer.

LIVE BRIEF
Snitch ILLUSTRATIVE
"Use search and ad library data to pick Snitch's next product category."

TRACK 4 · 2 SPRINTS

Creative *Floor*

END OF MONTH
Your Creator Lab channel is live, and you can take apart any ad and say why it works.

SPRINT 1

Reading *ads*

Learn to see what makes an ad work

WHAT YOU LEARN
- Anatomy of an ad: hook, story, proof, call to action
- Awareness levels: from unaware to ready to buy (Eugene Schwartz)
- Formats: Reels, Shorts, statics, carousels, film
- Building a swipe file
- How great Indian ads were made: case studies

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND
A swipe file of 50 ads in your category, with 10 full teardowns.

OUTCOME
A shared language for judging creative work.

LIVE BRIEF
Big Boy Toyz PARTNER
"Tear down 20 luxury car ads and find the one idea nobody in the category has used."

SPRINT 2

Phone-first *filmmaking*

Shoot well with what is in your pocket

WHAT YOU LEARN
- Shot types, framing and composition
- Light and sound on a phone
- Editing basics in CapCut and Premiere Pro
- Captions, pacing and the first three seconds
- AI tools for scripts, captions and cleanup

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND
Launch your Creator Lab channel: 5 posts in two weeks, including a 30-second "the problem I am solving" video.

OUTCOME
A live channel and your first published work.

LIVE BRIEF
HiveSchool PARTNER
"Make the reel that shows what day one on campus feels like."

MONTH 2 · MAKE IT AND SELL IT · TRACKS 1 AND 2

Product and *MVP*



MONTH-END PITCH
Early-stage accelerators

TRACK 1 · 2 SPRINTS

Venture *Studio*

END OF MONTH

A product in hand, a store that takes payments, and the first 10 orders from people you do not know.

SPRINT 1

From idea to *product*

Sourcing, samples and the cost of making one unit

WHAT YOU LEARN

- MVP types: private label, white label, made-to-order, own formulation
- Finding manufacturers: IndiaMART, trade fairs, contract manufacturers
- Samples, MOQs and negotiation
- Costing sheets: COGS, packaging, freight
- Compliance basics: labelling rules, FSSAI, BIS, GST registration
- Choosing an entity: proprietorship, LLP, private limited

WHAT YOU BUILD

Three supplier quotes, a sample in hand and a full costing sheet for your first product.

OUTCOME

A product you can hold and a cost you can defend.

LIVE BRIEF

Dohful PARTNER

"Cut the cost of a box by 10% without changing the taste."

SPRINT 2

Open for *business*

Pricing, unit economics and a store that works

WHAT YOU LEARN

- Pricing methods: cost-plus, value-based, Van Westendorp
- Order-level unit economics: shipping, gateway fees, COD and returns
- Setting up a Shopify store, payments and shipping (Shiprocket)
- COD, RTO and how they eat margin
- Customer support basics

WHAT YOU BUILD

Your store live, with unit economics per order, and the first 10 orders.

OUTCOME

First revenue, and a P&L per order.

LIVE BRIEF

Fixmycurls PARTNER

"Design the price ladder: a starter kit, single products and a refill."

TRACK 2 · 2 SPRINTS

Brand *House*

END OF MONTH

Your brand has a name, a position, an identity and a pack.

SPRINT 1

Positioning *that holds*

Decide what you stand for, and against whom

WHAT YOU LEARN

- Positioning: competitive alternatives and unique value (April Dunford)
- Brand pyramid and brand promise
- Brand archetypes and personality
- Tone of voice
- Testing positioning with customers

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND

A positioning statement, brand pyramid and tone-of-voice guide for your brand.

OUTCOME

A position you can say in one sentence.

LIVE BRIEF

Culture Circle PARTNER

"Position Culture Circle against the habit of buying sneakers abroad."

SPRINT 2

Name, identity *and pack*

What people see, hold and remember

WHAT YOU LEARN

- Naming: descriptive, evocative, invented; trademark checks on IP India
- Logo, colour and type systems
- Distinctive brand assets
- Packaging hierarchy, unboxing and shelf stand-out
- Labelling law on packs
- AI for identity exploration

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND

Name, identity system and pack design for your brand, with a trademark search.

OUTCOME

A brand identity ready for launch.

LIVE BRIEF

PeeSafe PARTNER

"Redesign a pack that can sit on a shared bathroom shelf without embarrassing anyone."

MONTH 2 · MAKE IT AND SELL IT · TRACKS 3 AND 4

Product and *MVP*



MONTH-END PITCH

Early-stage accelerators

TRACK 3 · 2 SPRINTS

Growth *Engine*

END OF MONTH

A tracked, converting store and your first customers without paid ads.

SPRINT 1

A store that *converts*

Landing pages, product pages and tracking

WHAT YOU LEARN

- Product page anatomy and trust signals
- Conversion rate optimisation basics
- Site speed and mobile checkout
- GA4, Meta Pixel and Conversions API set-up
- UTMs and clean tracking

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND

A fully tracked store with GA4, Pixel and CAPI, and five conversion fixes shipped.

OUTCOME

Data you can trust from day one.

LIVE BRIEF

Snitch ILLUSTRATIVE

"Audit a product page and find the five changes that would lift conversion most."

SPRINT 2

First customers, *no ads*

Founder-led selling and word of mouth

WHAT YOU LEARN

- Founder-led sales
- WhatsApp communities and broadcast lists
- Referral loops
- Campus ambassadors and college fests
- Marketplace listing basics

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND

Ten orders from strangers through unpaid channels.

OUTCOME

Proof that someone outside your circle will pay.

LIVE BRIEF

Dohful PARTNER

"Get 100 people to pre-order a flavour that does not exist yet."

TRACK 4 · 2 SPRINTS

Creative *Floor*

END OF MONTH

A founder film and a set of product images and statics ready for launch.

SPRINT 1

The brand film *you can afford*

Story, script and storyboard

WHAT YOU LEARN

- Story structure for short films
- Writing a two-column AV script
- Storyboards and shot lists
- The founder story
- Music, voice and sound

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND

A 60-second founder story film for your brand.

OUTCOME

A finished film with your name on it.

LIVE BRIEF

Big Boy Toyz PARTNER

"The ₹1 Crore Ad: sell a supercar to a buyer who already owns three."

SPRINT 2

Product *imagery*

Photos and statics that sell

WHAT YOU LEARN

- Product photography on a phone and lightbox
- Styling and set design
- AI product imagery: backgrounds and lifestyle scenes
- Static ad design in Canva and Figma
- Marketplace image rules

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND

Ten product images and five static ads for your brand.

OUTCOME

A launch-ready visual library.

LIVE BRIEF

Fixmycurls PARTNER

"Shoot a before and after that is honest, compliant and still stops the scroll."

MONTH 3 · LAUNCH IT · TRACKS 1 AND 2

Go-to-market



MONTH-END PITCH
Hive Incubation Cell, for iterations

TRACK 1 · 2 SPRINTS
Venture *Studio*

END OF MONTH
A launch plan executed, offline sales on record and a clear read on what sold.

SPRINT 1
The launch *plan*

Who you sell to first, where, and with what budget

WHAT YOU LEARN
- Go-to-market strategy and the beachhead customer
- Launch calendars
- Budget allocation for a small brand
- Inventory and fulfilment for launch week
- Customer service at launch

WHAT YOU BUILD
A 30-day launch plan with budget, run on your brand.

OUTCOME
A launch you ran, with numbers.

LIVE BRIEF
Dohful PARTNER
"Opening Day: launch a new store and get a city queuing outside on day one."

SPRINT 2
Selling *face to face*

Sell on Streets, pop-ups and sampling

WHAT YOU LEARN
- The sales pitch and objection handling
- Pop-ups, fests and flea markets
- Sampling and trial
- Offline payments and stock
- Learning from every no

WHAT YOU BUILD
Sell on Streets results, plus one pop-up for your brand.

OUTCOME
A revenue number, and what customers said to your face.

LIVE BRIEF
Partner brand, Sell on Streets
PARTNER
"Sell the most units of a partner brand's product in one market street, in one day."

TRACK 2 · 2 SPRINTS
Brand *House*

END OF MONTH
A launch campaign and your first creator and press coverage.

SPRINT 1
Launch *campaigns*

One idea, many places

WHAT YOU LEARN
- The big idea and campaign architecture
- Integrated plans: ATL, BTL and digital
- PR basics: press notes and pitching journalists
- Founder stories in the media
- Measuring a launch

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND
A launch campaign and a press note for your brand.

OUTCOME
A campaign plan and at least one press pitch sent.

LIVE BRIEF
Epigamia ILLUSTRATIVE
"Launch a new product line with a ₹10 lakh budget."

SPRINT 2
Creators *and community*

Getting other people to talk about you

WHAT YOU LEARN
- Creator tiers and how to pick them
- Barter vs paid vs affiliate deals
- Creator briefs and contracts
- ASCI influencer disclosure rules
- Building a community around a brand

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND
Seed your brand with 20 creators and track what comes back.

OUTCOME
Creator content live, with reach and sales tracked.

LIVE BRIEF
PeeSafe PARTNER
"Say It Out Loud: build a brand in a category people will not talk about."

MONTH 3 · LAUNCH IT · TRACKS 3 AND 4

Go-to-market



MONTH-END PITCH
Hive Incubation Cell, for iterations

TRACK 3 · 2 SPRINTS

Growth *Engine*

END OF MONTH

Paid campaigns live on Meta and Google, with a testing plan and clean reporting.

SPRINT 1

Meta *ads*

How Facebook and Instagram ads work now

WHAT YOU LEARN

+ Account structure and campaign types, including Advantage+
+ Broad targeting, and why creative now does the targeting
+ Creative diversification for Meta's ad system (Andromeda)
+ Events, the learning phase and budgets
+ Conversions API and reporting

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND

Your first Meta campaign for your brand, with a test plan.

OUTCOME

A live campaign, and a read of what worked.

LIVE BRIEF

Snitch ILLUSTRATIVE

"Plan the Meta campaign for a sale week with a fixed budget and a target ROAS."

SPRINT 2

Google *and YouTube*

Catching people who are already looking

WHAT YOU LEARN

+ Search campaigns and keyword strategy
+ Brand vs generic terms
+ Merchant Center and Shopping
+ Performance Max
+ YouTube ads

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND

A search and shopping campaign for your brand.

OUTCOME

Search campaigns running, with cost per order tracked.

LIVE BRIEF

Lenskart ILLUSTRATIVE

"Win searches for "eyeglasses near me" in one city without raising the budget."

TRACK 4 · 2 SPRINTS

Creative *Floor*

END OF MONTH

Twenty ad variants tested and one shoot directed by you.

SPRINT 1

Performance *creative*

Ads built to be tested

WHAT YOU LEARN

+ Hooks: the first three seconds
+ UGC and creator-style scripts
+ The angle, persona and format matrix
+ Creative testing and reading results
+ Iterating winners

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND

Twenty ad variants for your brand, made with an AI creative workflow, and tested.

OUTCOME

At least one winning ad, and the reason it won.

LIVE BRIEF

Fixmycurls PARTNER

"Category Zero: create a market for curly hair care where buyers do not know they need a product."

SPRINT 2

Shoot *day*

Directing people and running a set

WHAT YOU LEARN

+ Pre-production: call sheets, shot lists, budgets
+ Directing talent and non-actors
+ Lighting and audio on set
+ B-roll and coverage
+ Wrapping, backing up and logging footage

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND

Direct one shoot for your brand, from call sheet to wrap.

OUTCOME

Raw footage and a directing credit.

LIVE BRIEF

Culture Circle PARTNER

"Film a sneaker drop so people feel they missed out."

MONTH 4 · EVERYWHERE PEOPLE BUY · TRACKS 1 AND 2

Scale across *channels*



MONTH-END PITCH
A room of CMOs and brand heads, on your GTM and channel plan

TRACK 1 · 2 SPRINTS

Venture *Studio*

END OF MONTH

A P&L by channel and an operations playbook that can handle growth.

SPRINT 1

Channel *economics*

Where you make money and where you lose it

WHAT YOU LEARN

+ Marketplace fees and commissions
+ Quick commerce margins, listing and visibility costs
+ D2C vs marketplace vs quick commerce P&L
+ Contribution margin by channel
+ Working capital and inventory days

WHAT YOU BUILD

A channel P&L for your brand, and a decision on which channel to add next.

OUTCOME

A channel decision you can back with numbers.

LIVE BRIEF

A snack brand in the HiveSchool building

ILLUSTRATIVE

"Should a ₹5 crore brand go onto quick commerce now, or wait a year?"

SPRINT 2

Operations *at scale*

Stock, fulfilment and the first hires

WHAT YOU LEARN

+ Demand forecasting and inventory planning
+ 3PLs and warehousing
+ Replenishing dark stores
+ Returns and customer support SLAs
+ Hiring your first team

WHAT YOU BUILD

An operations playbook for your brand for the next three months.

OUTCOME

A playbook that keeps you in stock.

LIVE BRIEF

Dohful PARTNER

"Plan stock and staffing for three stores during the festive season."

TRACK 2 · 2 SPRINTS

Brand *House*

END OF MONTH

Your brand looks and feels the same on every shelf and screen, and has one collab pitched.

SPRINT 1

Brand *on every shelf*

Marketplaces, quick commerce and retail

WHAT YOU LEARN

+ A+ content and brand stores on marketplaces
+ Brand presence on quick commerce apps
+ Retail shelf and visual merchandising
+ Trade marketing basics
+ Keeping one brand across channels

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND

A+ content and a marketplace brand store for your brand.

OUTCOME

Your brand live and consistent on a new channel.

LIVE BRIEF

Snitch ILLUSTRATIVE

"Make a Snitch store feel like the Instagram feed people already follow."

SPRINT 2

Collabs *and partnerships*

Borrowing attention from other brands

WHAT YOU LEARN

+ Co-branding and collab drops
+ Licensing
+ Sponsorships and events
+ Experiential marketing
+ Measuring partnerships

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND

One collab pitched for your brand to a real partner.

OUTCOME

A collab deck sent, and a reply.

LIVE BRIEF

Big Boy Toyz PARTNER

"Design a collab between a luxury car showroom and a fashion label."

MONTH 4 · EVERYWHERE PEOPLE BUY · TRACKS 3 AND 4

Scale across *channels*



MONTH-END PITCH
A room of CMOs and brand heads, on your GTM and channel plan

TRACK 3 · 3 SPRINTS

Growth *Engine*

END OF MONTH

Your brand listed and advertising on a marketplace, with a quick commerce plan and a search audit.

SPRINT 1

Marketplaces

Amazon, Flipkart, Myntra, Nykaa

WHAT YOU LEARN

+ How marketplace search ranks listings
+ Listing optimisation and reviews
+ Sponsored Products, Brands and Display
+ Flipkart Ads
+ ROAS vs TACoS
+ Sale events: Prime Day, Big Billion Days

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND

Your brand listed on one marketplace with ads running.

OUTCOME

Marketplace sales and ads data from your own brand.

LIVE BRIEF

Mamaearth ILLUSTRATIVE

"Hold rank on a hero product during a sale event when every competitor is discounting."

SPRINT 2

Quick *commerce*

Blinkit, Zepto and Instamart

WHAT YOU LEARN

+ How dark stores and city-level listing work
+ Getting listed and staying in stock
+ Search and visibility inside the apps
+ Blinkit, Zepto and Instamart ads
+ Sampling and key account management

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND

A quick commerce launch plan for your brand, by city and pincode.

OUTCOME

A plan a quick commerce buyer would take seriously.

LIVE BRIEF

Cipla ILLUSTRATIVE

"Win the 10-minute aisle for an over-the-counter health brand."

SPRINT 3

Search *and AI answers*

SEO, and showing up in ChatGPT and Gemini

WHAT YOU LEARN

+ Technical, on-page and content SEO
+ Keyword clusters and content plans
+ Generative engine optimisation: being cited in AI answers
+ Reviews, forums and Reddit as sources
+ Measuring organic growth

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND

An SEO and AI search audit for your brand, with ten fixes.

OUTCOME

A search plan, and your brand appearing for at least one target query.

LIVE BRIEF

Fixmycurls PARTNER

"Be the answer when someone asks an AI how to care for curly hair."

TRACK 4 · 2 SPRINTS

Creative *Floor*

END OF MONTH

Channel-ready creative and your first AI-assisted videos.

SPRINT 1

Creative *for every channel*

Marketplaces, quick commerce and banners

WHAT YOU LEARN

+ Marketplace images and A+ creative
+ In-app creatives for quick commerce
+ Banner sizes and adaptation
+ Creative for sale events
+ Briefing designers

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND

A creative kit for your brand across three channels.

OUTCOME

A full creative kit, ready to upload.

LIVE BRIEF

boAt ILLUSTRATIVE

"Build the creative kit for a sale-day launch across Amazon, Flipkart and Blinkit."

SPRINT 2

Motion *and AI video*

Animation and generated video

WHAT YOU LEARN

+ Motion graphics basics
+ AI video tools for scenes and product shots
+ AI voice and music, and licensing
+ Mixing filmed and generated footage
+ Where AI video works and where it does not

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND

Three AI-assisted videos for your brand.

OUTCOME

AI video work in your portfolio.

LIVE BRIEF

Big Boy Toyz PARTNER

"Make a car launch film without a car on set."

MONTH 5 · PROVE PEOPLE COME BACK · TRACKS 1 AND 2

PMF *signals*



MONTH-END PITCH

Angel investors

TRACK 1 · 2 SPRINTS

Venture *Studio*

END OF MONTH

A PMF dashboard and a clear call: double down, fix or pivot.

SPRINT 1

Is it *working?*

Measuring product-market fit

WHAT YOU LEARN

- The Sean Ellis test
- Retention curves and cohorts
- NPS and qualitative signals
- Contribution margin: CM1, CM2, CM3
- Pivot, persevere or stop

WHAT YOU BUILD

A PMF dashboard for your brand: repeat rate, CAC, contribution margin.

OUTCOME

An honest verdict on your brand, with numbers.

LIVE BRIEF

A startup in the HiveSchool building

ILLUSTRATIVE

"Six months in, growth has stalled. Pivot or persevere?"

SPRINT 2

Pricing *and margin*

Making each order worth more

WHAT YOU LEARN

- Price increases without losing buyers
- Bundles and AOV
- Subscriptions
- Discount discipline
- Gross margin levers

WHAT YOU BUILD

A margin plan for your brand, with one change shipped.

OUTCOME

Better margin on every order.

LIVE BRIEF

Epigamia ILLUSTRATIVE

"Raise prices by 8% without losing repeat buyers."

TRACK 2 · 2 SPRINTS

Brand *House*

END OF MONTH

A brand health tracker and a community programme for your brand.

SPRINT 1

Brand *health*

Is the brand getting stronger?

WHAT YOU LEARN

- Brand tracking: awareness, consideration, preference
- Share of search
- Ratings, reviews and reputation
- Online reputation management
- Brand vs performance spend

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND

A brand health tracker for your brand.

OUTCOME

A tracker you update every month.

LIVE BRIEF

Lenskart ILLUSTRATIVE

"Find out whether ads are building the brand or only buying sales."

SPRINT 2

Loyalty *and community*

Turning buyers into fans

WHAT YOU LEARN

- Loyalty programmes that work
- Community building
- UGC and reviews
- Ambassador programmes
- Brand rituals

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND

A community and loyalty programme for your brand, launched with your first buyers.

OUTCOME

Your first repeat buyers, by name.

LIVE BRIEF

Culture Circle PARTNER

"Turn one-time sneaker buyers into a community that shows up for every drop."

MONTH 5 · PROVE PEOPLE COME BACK · TRACKS 3 AND 4

PMF *signals*



MONTH-END PITCH

Angel investors

TRACK 3 · 2 SPRINTS

Growth *Engine*

END OF MONTH

A live retention journey, a weekly dashboard and one experiment with a clear result.

SPRINT 1

CRM *and retention*

WhatsApp, email and lifecycle journeys

WHAT YOU LEARN

+ WhatsApp marketing: templates and opt-in rules
+ Email flows
+ RFM segmentation
+ Lifecycle journeys: welcome, repeat, win-back
+ Loyalty mechanics

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND

One automated retention journey live on your brand.

OUTCOME

A measurable lift in repeat orders.

LIVE BRIEF

Licious ILLUSTRATIVE

"Bring back customers who ordered once and never returned."

SPRINT 2

Analytics *and experiments*

Knowing what caused what

WHAT YOU LEARN

+ GA4 in depth
+ Attribution models and their limits
+ A/B tests and sample sizes
+ Incrementality and lift tests
+ Dashboards in Looker Studio
+ SQL basics

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND

A weekly growth dashboard and one A/B test on your brand.

OUTCOME

A test result you can explain in one slide.

LIVE BRIEF

Snitch ILLUSTRATIVE

"Find out if a sale actually brought new customers, or only discounted existing ones."

TRACK 4 · 2 SPRINTS

Creative *Floor*

END OF MONTH

A content system that runs every week, and a pilot episode for a series.

SPRINT 1

Content *systems*

Publishing every day without burning out

WHAT YOU LEARN

+ Content pillars and calendars
+ Repurposing one shoot into twenty posts
+ Brand channels led by creators
+ Community management
+ Reading content analytics

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND

A 30-day content system for your brand, running.

OUTCOME

Thirty days of content published.

LIVE BRIEF

PeeSafe PARTNER

"Build a month of content that makes a taboo category easy to talk about."

SPRINT 2

Long-form *and series*

YouTube, podcasts and docu-series

WHAT YOU LEARN

+ Episodic storytelling
+ YouTube long-form
+ Podcasts
+ Docu-series production
+ Distribution and clips

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND

A pilot episode of a series for your brand.

OUTCOME

A pilot ready to publish.

LIVE BRIEF

HiveSchool PARTNER

"Make episode one of the HiveSchool founder documentary series."

MONTH 6 · DEMO DAY · TRACKS 1 AND 2

Fundraise



MONTH-END PITCH
Fellowship Demo Day: investors, VCs and founders, to raise a cheque

TRACK 1 · 2 SPRINTS

Venture *Studio*

END OF MONTH
A financial model, a data room and a Demo Day pitch for your brand.

SPRINT 1

The *money*

How consumer brands raise in India

WHAT YOU LEARN
+ Angels, angel networks, accelerators and micro VCs
+ Revenue-based financing
+ Instruments: equity, CCPS, CCDs, iSAFE notes
+ Valuation, dilution and cap tables
+ Term sheet terms
+ DPIIT startup recognition

WHAT YOU BUILD
A 24-month financial model and cap table for your brand.

OUTCOME
A model an investor can poke at.

LIVE BRIEF
A startup in the HiveSchool building
ILLUSTRATIVE
"Two term sheets on the table. Which one should the founder sign?"

SPRINT 2

The *pitch*

The deck, the data room and the room

WHAT YOU LEARN
+ The story arc of a pitch
+ A 10-slide deck
+ The data room
+ Investor pipelines and follow-ups
+ Handling hard questions

WHAT YOU BUILD
Your Demo Day deck and data room.

OUTCOME
A pitch that has been tested on angels and on the stage.

LIVE BRIEF
Hive Incubation Cell
PARTNER
"Prepare a founder in the Incubation Cell for their first investor meeting."

TRACK 2 · 2 SPRINTS

Brand *House*

END OF MONTH
A press kit and a three-year brand plan for your brand.

SPRINT 1

The brand *story*

For investors, press and future hires

WHAT YOU LEARN
+ Brand narrative for investors
+ Founder personal brand
+ PR for a funding announcement
+ Press kits
+ Employer brand basics

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND
A press kit and founder narrative for your brand.

OUTCOME
A press kit ready to send.

LIVE BRIEF
Big Boy Toyz PARTNER
"Tell the founding story so a business paper wants to run it."

SPRINT 2

Brand *architecture*

What comes after the first product

WHAT YOU LEARN
+ Line extensions and sub-brands
+ Entering new categories
+ Brand architecture models
+ When to launch a second brand
+ Portfolio thinking

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND
A three-year brand architecture plan for your brand.

OUTCOME
A brand plan that investors can see.

LIVE BRIEF
Epigamia ILLUSTRATIVE
"Should the next launch carry the Epigamia name, or a new one?"

MONTH 6 · DEMO DAY · TRACKS 3 AND 4

Fundraise



MONTH-END PITCH
Fellowship Demo Day: investors, VCs and founders, to raise a cheque

TRACK 3 · 2 SPRINTS

Growth *Engine*

END OF MONTH
A 12-month growth model and media plan for your brand.

SPRINT 1

Media *planning*

Biddable and non-biddable, together

WHAT YOU LEARN
- Biddable media: search, social, programmatic, retail media
- Non-biddable media: TV, OTT and CTV, OOH, print, radio, sponsorships
- Earned and owned media: PR, SEO, community
- Media mix and reach planning
- Working with media agencies

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND
A 12-month media plan for your brand.

OUTCOME
A media plan with reach, frequency and cost.

LIVE BRIEF
Dohful PARTNER
"Plan media for five new store openings with one fixed budget."

SPRINT 2

The growth *model*

Forecasting and budget decisions

WHAT YOU LEARN
- Growth forecasting
- Budget allocation across channels
- Scenario planning
- Marketing mix modelling basics
- The metrics investors read

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND
A 12-month growth forecast for your brand, tied to the financial model.

OUTCOME
A forecast you will present at Demo Day.

LIVE BRIEF
Snitch ILLUSTRATIVE
"Where should the next ₹1 crore of marketing go?"

TRACK 4 · 2 SPRINTS

Creative *Floor*

END OF MONTH
Your Demo Day film and a personal showreel for placements.

SPRINT 1

Demo Day *production*

The film, the slides and the stage

WHAT YOU LEARN
- Pitch video production
- Presentation design
- Stage and event design
- Rehearsal and delivery
- Live content from the event

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND
Your Demo Day film and slides.

OUTCOME
A finished film played on stage.

LIVE BRIEF
Hive Incubation Cell
PARTNER
"Produce the opening film for Fellowship Demo Day."

SPRINT 2

The *showreel*

Your portfolio for placement season

WHAT YOU LEARN
- Case-study writing
- Showreel editing
- Portfolio sites
- Talking about your work in interviews
- Personal brand on LinkedIn and Instagram

CAPSTONE ON YOUR BRAND
A personal showreel and portfolio site.

OUTCOME
A portfolio ready for placement season.

LIVE BRIEF
Your future employer
ILLUSTRATIVE
"Show a hiring manager in 90 seconds why they should hire you."

WEEKLY BRAND CHALLENGES

Brands that have set *live briefs*

- Big Boy Toyz
- Dohful
- Pee Safe
- Fix My Curls
- Culture Circle
- Bla Bli Blu

Every Wednesday a brand walks in with a problem it has right now. **Teams of four get seven days.** The brand's own leaders judge the pitch, and **they can hire on the spot.**

Day 1 · The brief | **Days 2 to 6 · The build week** | **Day 7 · The boardroom**

01 **Big Boy Toyz · *The ₹1 Crore Ad***

Make the ad that sells the fourth car: one film, one print and a media plan.

02 **Dohful · *Opening Day***

Launch a cookie brand's first QSR store and get the city queuing on day one.

03 **Pee Safe · *Say It Out Loud***

Get people talking about a product they would rather not mention.

04 **Fix My Curls · *Category Zero***

Create the category before you sell the product.

05 **Culture Circle · *The Trust Trade***

Win the first purchase from a buyer who has never bought resale.

06 **Bla Bli Blu · *Scent Without the Sample***

Sell a fragrance to someone who has never smelled it.

THE VERDICT

Hire	Interview	Pass
Pre-placement offer	Fast track to the final round	Written feedback

Shipped

with real brands

Brands built by *students*

Launched from campus by HiveSchool batches



Crumbgasm



Gripply



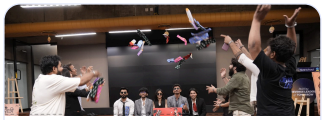
Koi Perfumes



Panchhi



Shehri Co.



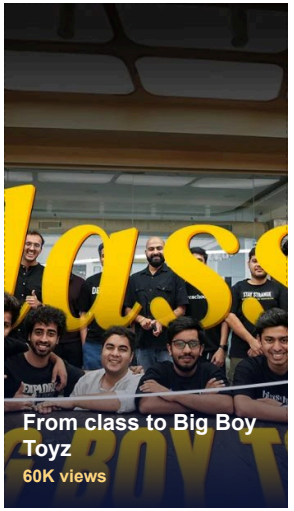
Toemahtoes

Graduate with a page, **a brand and a portfolio**

A certificate says you attended. A film with views, a page with numbers and a product sold on the street say what you can do. This is the work the first batches shipped with partner brands.



Inside Culture Circle
595K views



From class to Big Boy Toyz
60K views



Dominating the curly market
21K views

After the Fellowship

Hired *or funded.*



24 roles across five categories, from creative and agency to brand, commerce and growth, with a **target CTC range of 4.5 to 12 LPA.**

01

Get hired

A placement season with **creative, agency, brand, commerce and growth** recruiters. **Pre-placement offers** from the weekly challenges count too.

02

Get funded

The **₹50 lakh Fellowship Incubation Investment Fund** backs the strongest brands from Demo Day, with investment, mentors and workspace in the **Hive Incubation Cell.**

03

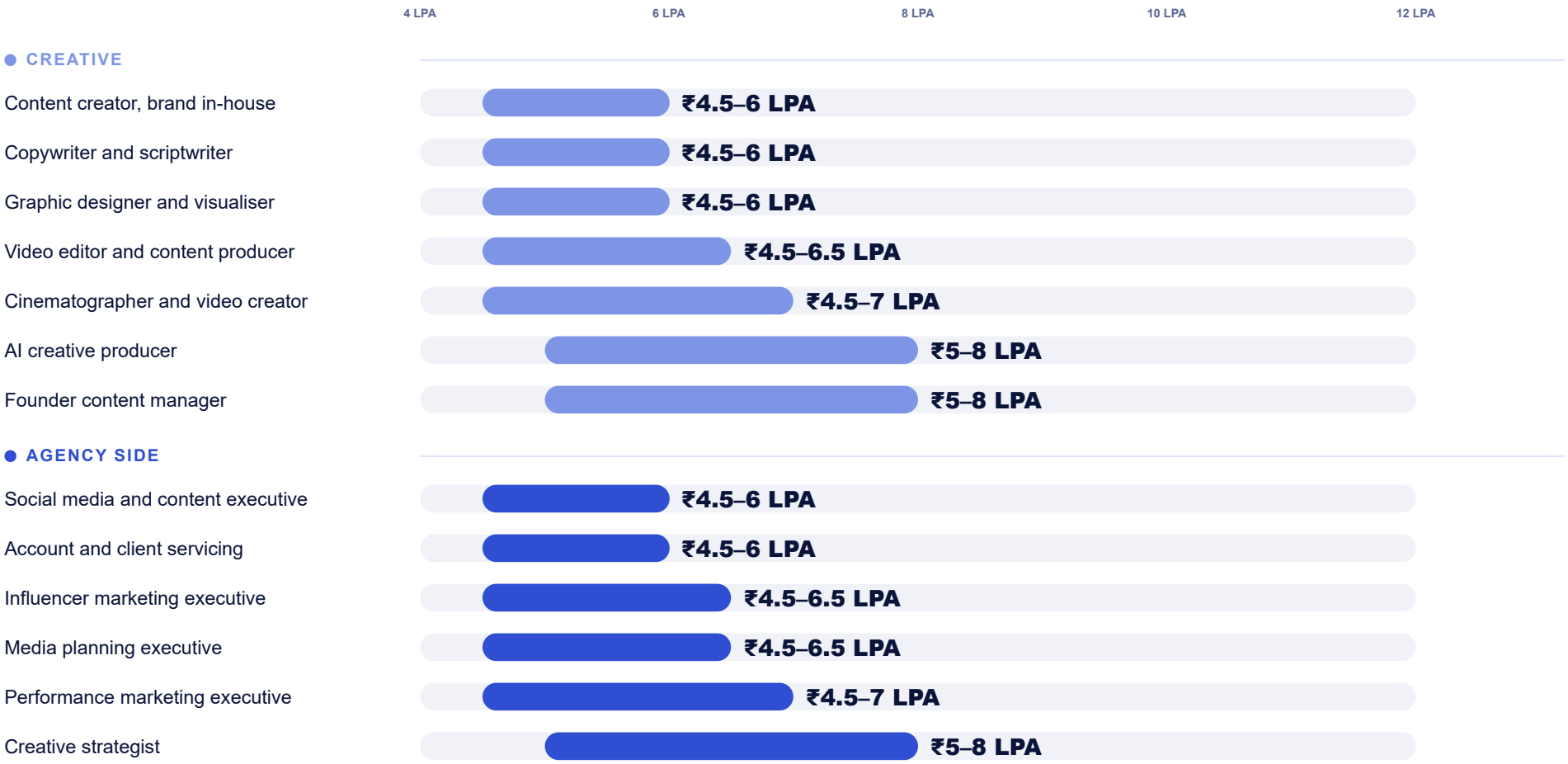
A five to seven year trajectory

YEAR 0	YEARS 1–2	YEARS 3–4	YEARS 5–7	THEN
Fellowship	First job	Manager	Head of marketing	CMO

AFTER THE FELLOWSHIP

Roles you can get *placed into*

Target CTC range, LPA

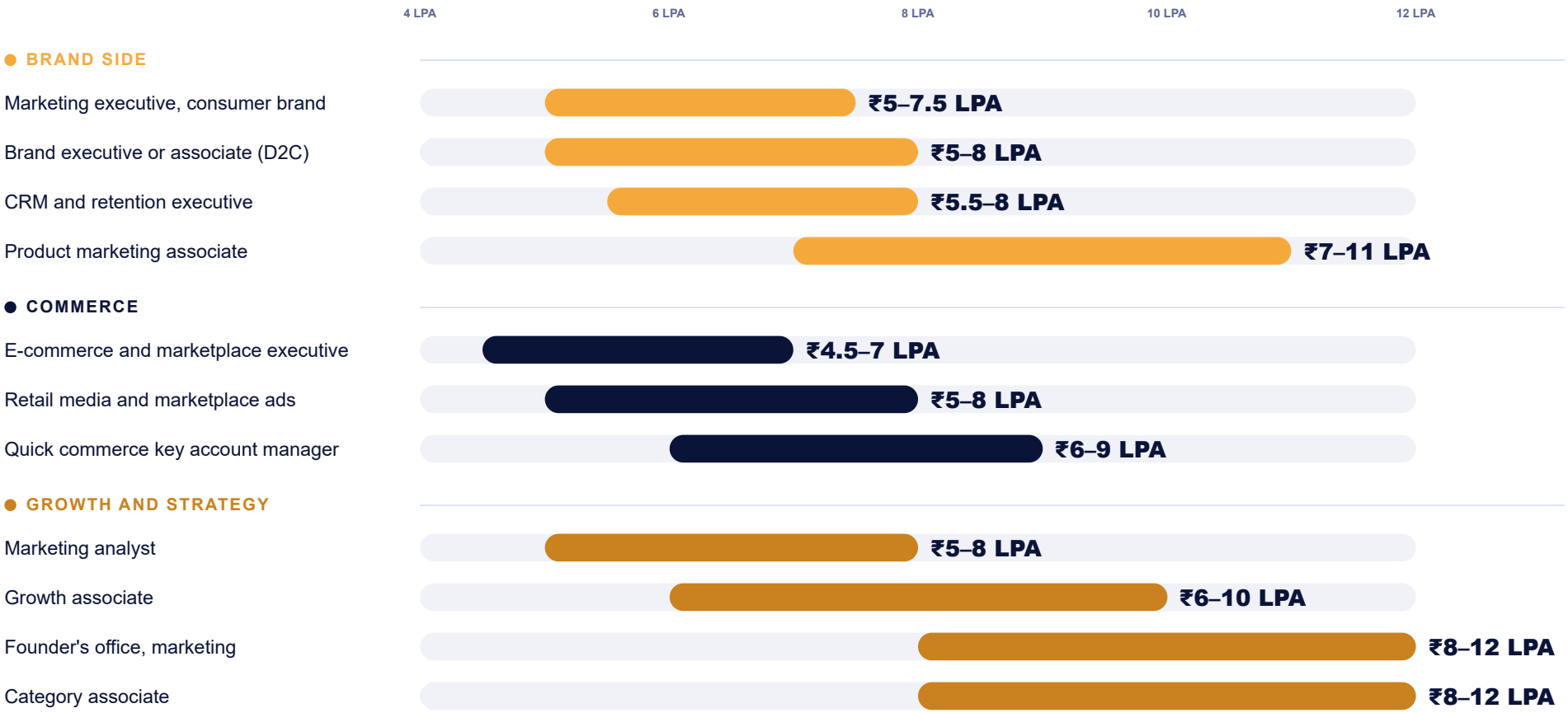


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AFTER THE FELLOWSHIP

Roles you can get *placed into*

Target CTC range, LPA



Target ranges for the first batch, set against current market pay for these roles. Every outcome will be published with name, role, company and fixed pay, reported separately from variable pay. 24 roles across five categories.

Meet the Mentors

Nestlé | Cipla | MoEngage | Patanjali

Swiggy | Tata 1mg | Phab | Noise

Hocco | Pee Safe | upGrad | Zepto

District | Philips | LinkedIn | Sleepy Owl

4700BC | Culture Circle | Zypp Electric

Founders, CMOs and brand heads who **teach the modules, sit on the challenge panels and hire from the batch.** This is the room you learn from, and the room you pitch to.

Saurabh Sen Gupta
VP Sales, Zomato

Siddarth Menon
CMO, Epigamia

Neha Gulati
Marketing Head, Nestlé

Trilok
Tata Consumer

Amit Jawar
Patanjali

Kartik
Blinkit

Devgarh
Zepto

Darpan
IND Money

Ragini
Fynd

Yamika
Favcy, Waterbridge, PedalStart, GroowX

Jayant and Rishika
Fix My Curls

Arushi
Dohful

Chaman
Dohful

Chirag
Deyor

Sheena
Zenma Coffee

Roni Mondal
Maitri

Atovio
Anmay

Admission Process

No entrance exam and no marketing background needed. **We select on what you would build, not what you have memorised.**

Round 1

Discovery call with Head of Admissions

+ A short call to understand who you are, what you have built so far and why the Fellowship.

Round 2

Business case discussion with panel

+ A live case on a real brand, discussed with a panel of mentors and programme faculty.

Round 3

Culture fit call

+ A final conversation on drive, clarity and fit with the batch.



Programme *fee*

Item	Fellowship, Batch of 2027
Programme fee	₹6,00,000 + GST
Duration	9 months, full time
Residential	Optional, opt in
Scholarships	Merit, Builders, CXO Advisory Board
Seats	**Handpicked 50**

Batch starts April 2027, on campus at HiveSchool, Huda City Centre, Gurugram.

Residence: The programme is full time on campus, and residence is optional. [Confirm residential fee and capacity.]

Career *Pathways*

Two ways out: get hired, or get funded.

Google · Microsoft · Amazon · Adobe · Nestlé · Tata Consumer
Cipla · Tata 1mg · Swiggy · Zomato · Zepto · MakeMyTrip
Shiprocket · Razorpay · GoKwik · boAt · Lenskart · Noise
Snitch · Epigamia · Libas · Culture Circle · Big Boy Toyz · Pee Safe

Job Placement

- Target CTC range of **4.5 to 12 LPA**
- **24 roles across five categories**: creative, agency, brand, commerce, growth

Entrepreneurship

- **₹50 lakh** Fellowship Incubation Investment Fund
- Founders move into the **Hive Incubation Cell**

Pre-Placement Offers

- Weekly challenges end in **Hire, Interview or Pass**
- A Hire is a **pre-placement offer**



Grow a page. Build a brand.

Start your career.

Start application
hiveschool.co/ai-marketing

Talk to us
Book a 30-minute call

hiveschool .

For any queries, contact

admissions@hiveschool.co Huda City Centre, Gurugram

Featured on Shark Tank India S4

ET Emerging B-School of the Year 2026